

Kangra Fort near Dharamshala, Himachal Pradesh

ART ▼

ECHOES OF POWER

Kangra Fort will set the stage for the next showcase of Panorama Editions

Curated by award-winning artist and filmmaker Sarah Singh, the fifth volume of Panorama Editions will be held at Kangra Fort near Dharamshala this October. Titled *Ten Nights By A Lost River*, the three-day art salon will explore the theme of power through theatrical installations, music and dance. "The royal family here traces their lineage back 2,500 years, and one of their ancestors (that they claim) is King Porus, who was in the major battle with Alexander the Great. These are all battleground areas and there are these historical connections with the broader region. Himachal Pradesh is known as Veer Bhoomi or the land of the brave," says Sarah.

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The theatrical installations will unfold like a gallery of about 15 scenes, with guests moving around and getting different perspectives or seeing scenes in varying contexts. "Power is so many things, and one of the things I'm exploring is the cycle of power and how it can be exchanged. I don't mean it in the literal sense; I'm not staging a sword fight," says Sarah. There will be an exploration of whether female power is fierceness or entrapment. Then there's the direct representation of male muscular power as well as the Wild West cowboy trope.

Another element of the salon will be a tented encampment dinner where guests will experience the traditional dham, prepared and served by Himachali pandits. Sarah has collaborated with renowned Delhi-based textile designer Peter D'Ascoli to design a special distressed brocade material for the tent. She has also roped in students from the NIFT Kangra to participate through performance, design interventions and backstage support.

The main event will be a free public concert at Police Ground, Dharamshala, by Spanish singer-songwriter Le Parody (Sole Parody), accompanied by Cuban trumpet player Frank Santiuste. They will be joined by performers from Austria and Hungary as well as artists from Himachal Pradesh and other parts of India.

Sarah will later showcase elements from the art salon—like the staging and garments—at the Liszt Institute Delhi; the exhibition will run from October 12 for two weeks.

—Prachi Joshi

***(Panorama Editions** will be held from **October 3 to 5**)*